

How I Made My Website's Colors Work Like Paint Buckets

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So I built this personal website for the internship (you can see it live at my Netlify link), and there's this one part I didn't fully get at first but now actually makes sense — the color system.

At the very top of my CSS code, there's this block called `:root`. It looks like this:

```
:root {  
  --bg: #0f0f11;  
  --surface: #18181b;  
  --text: #f4f4f5;  
  --accent: #6366f1;  
  --border: #27272a;  
}
```

At first I was like, why not just write the color codes directly where I need them? Why create these `--thing` labels?

Here's what I figured out: it's basically **paint buckets with labels on them**.

Imagine you're painting your room. Instead of telling the painter "use the can with code RAL 7021" every single time, you put a big label on the can that says "Wall Color." Now every time someone asks "what color for the walls?" you just say "use the Wall Color bucket."

That's exactly what `:root` does. It's the top of the tree — the trunk. Everything else branches out from it. By putting my colors inside `:root`, I'm saying: "These 6 labeled buckets are available everywhere on the page."

Then whenever I want to use a color, instead of writing the ugly hex code like `#0f0f11`, I write `var(--bg)`. The `var()` part just means "go look inside the bucket labeled `--bg` and use whatever's in there."

Why this actually matters:

If I decide tomorrow that I want the accent color to be green instead of purple, I change ONE line — `--accent: #22c55e;` — and every button, every link hover, every highlight on the entire page turns green instantly. I don't have to hunt through 50 lines of code looking for every place I used purple.

It's like if you decided to repaint all your doors. You just swap the paint inside the "Door Color" bucket. Every instruction that says "use Door Color" automatically gives you the new color. You don't rewrite the instructions.

Before this internship I thought styling a website meant manually coloring every element. Turns out the pros set up a system first, then let the system do the work. Way smarter.

This is a real piece from my PF-04 build. The full code is in my deployed site's index.html file.